

CHECKLIST

The Self-Employed Document Checklist

My Grate Mortgage Checklist · 5 min read

Self-employed borrowers have more options than ever — but the smoothest closings start with the right paperwork. Gather these once and you'll move through underwriting far faster, whether you go conventional or bank-statement.

Identity & basics

- ☐ Government-issued photo ID
- ☐ Social Security number / tax ID
- ☐ Current address history (typically 2 years)

Proof of self-employment

- ☐ Business license or registration
- ☐ A CPA or licensed tax preparer letter (if available)
- ☐ Website or professional listing that confirms your business

Income documentation

What you'll need depends on the loan type — your loan officer will tell you which path fits:

- ☐ **Bank statement loan:** 12–24 months of consecutive bank statements (personal and/or business — no gaps)
- ☐ **Conventional:** 2 years of personal and business tax returns, with all schedules
- ☐ Year-to-date profit & loss statement
- ☐ 1099s, if you receive them

Questions? Call or text (323) 313-8761

MyGrateMortgage.com

Your loan officer: Anthony “Tony” Pelayo · NMLS #1501920

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Assets & reserves

- ☐ Recent statements for checking, savings, and investment accounts
- ☐ Documentation for the source of your down payment
- ☐ Proof of reserves left after closing

Property (once you're under contract)

- ☐ Purchase agreement
- ☐ Homeowners insurance quote
- ☐ Most recent mortgage statement (if refinancing)

Consistency is everything: statements with no gaps, deposits you can explain, and one clear account where your income lands.

A few pro tips

- Keep business and personal banking separate — it makes deposit analysis far cleaner.
- Avoid large transfers between accounts right before applying; they raise questions.
- If a deposit is unusual (a tax refund, a gift, a one-time sale), keep a note explaining it.

Ready when you are

Send us what you have and we'll tell you exactly what's missing — and which program lets you qualify on your true income.

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